Standard Precautions, Transmission Risk, and Safe Injections

NURSING · nursing-foundations · BoardPrep lesson v1

Official examination scope

PRC Resolution No. 10 s. 2025 adopts the enhanced Nurses Licensure Examination TOS for November 2025 and later schedules. This lesson selects infection-prevention principles for nursing practice. Follow current public-health guidance, patient condition, product instructions, and facility policy; no frequency claim is made.

Learning objectives

- Apply Standard Precautions to all patient care and assess exposure before selecting PPE.
- Recognize when transmission-based precautions add measures to Standard Precautions.
- Explain how hand hygiene and single-use sterile injection equipment interrupt avoidable
- transmission.

1. Start with Standard Precautions

Standard Precautions apply to every patient in every care setting, regardless of known infection status. They include hand hygiene, safe injection practices, environmental and equipment controls, respiratory hygiene, and exposure-based PPE. Gloves do not replace hand hygiene. Follow the indicated care moments and clean hands after removing PPE.

2. Add measures for transmission risk

Use current transmission-based guidance when a suspected or confirmed condition warrants additional contact, droplet, or airborne controls. Check the required pathway, room controls, respiratory protection, equipment, and transport plan. Exact precautions depend on the organism, task, setting, and current guidance.

3. Match PPE and equipment to the task

Before suctioning or close care, consider contact with secretions, contaminated surfaces, and splash or aerosol exposure. Prepare the required PPE and dedicated or reprocessed equipment, then plan safe disposal and hand hygiene. A procedure name alone does not replace the risk assessment or isolation pathway.

4. Keep injections aseptic

Use a new sterile needle and syringe for each patient and each injection. Never reuse a syringe or use a used needle to enter a medication vial or solution container. Follow product labeling and facility policy for vial access, storage, and discard.

Prepare to suction a patient on contact precautions

Question: What should the nurse check before entering?
1. Confirm current isolation instructions and expected contact with secretions and equipment.
2. Select PPE and hand-hygiene steps required by the task and facility protocol.
3. Prepare equipment, disposal, and any room or transport controls.
Answer: Verify exposure risk, PPE, hand hygiene, equipment, disposal, and the current precaution pathway.
Check: The plan includes routine Standard Precautions and additional contact controls.

Access a multidose vial

Question: What prevents syringe-mediated transmission?
1. Use a new sterile needle and syringe for the patient and injection.
2. Do not re-enter the vial with used equipment.

3. Follow product labeling and facility rules for storage and discard.
Answer: Use single-use sterile injection equipment and an aseptic vial-access process.
Check: Needle and syringe are not shared between patients or reused for another vial entry.

Common misconceptions

- Standard Precautions apply only after infection is diagnosed.
- Gloves remove the need for hand hygiene.
- One PPE set is appropriate for every task and setting.
- A multidose vial makes used injection equipment safe to reuse.

Practice patterns

- Select preparation steps from a stated task and exposure risk.
- Combine Standard Precautions with indicated transmission-based controls.
- Identify unsafe medication or injection practices.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Subjects in the Nurses Licensure Examination — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/2025-10%20%20published%20Enhanced%20TOS%20nuse.pdf

Instructional references

Instructional reference: Core Infection Prevention and Control Practices — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/core-practices/
Instructional reference: Isolation Precautions Guideline — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/precautions.html
Instructional reference: Safe Injection Practices to Prevent Transmission of Infections to Patients — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/injection-safety/hcp/clinical-guidance/
Instructional reference: CDC Isolation Precautions Guideline — Section II.H: Transport of Patients — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/prevention.html
Instructional reference: CDC Isolation Precautions Guideline — Section III: Precautions to Prevent Transmission — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/precautions.html

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